

The Calypso

Volume 49 Issue 5 Sept 2026

The Newsletter of the Greater Lansing Orchid Society

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CALYPSO DEADLINE:

October 16 for the Nov. issue

The purposes for which the Society is organized are to create an awareness of orchid culture; to foster the preservation of native species of orchids; to support research and development of orchid culture; and to hold meetings, lectures, and exhibitions.

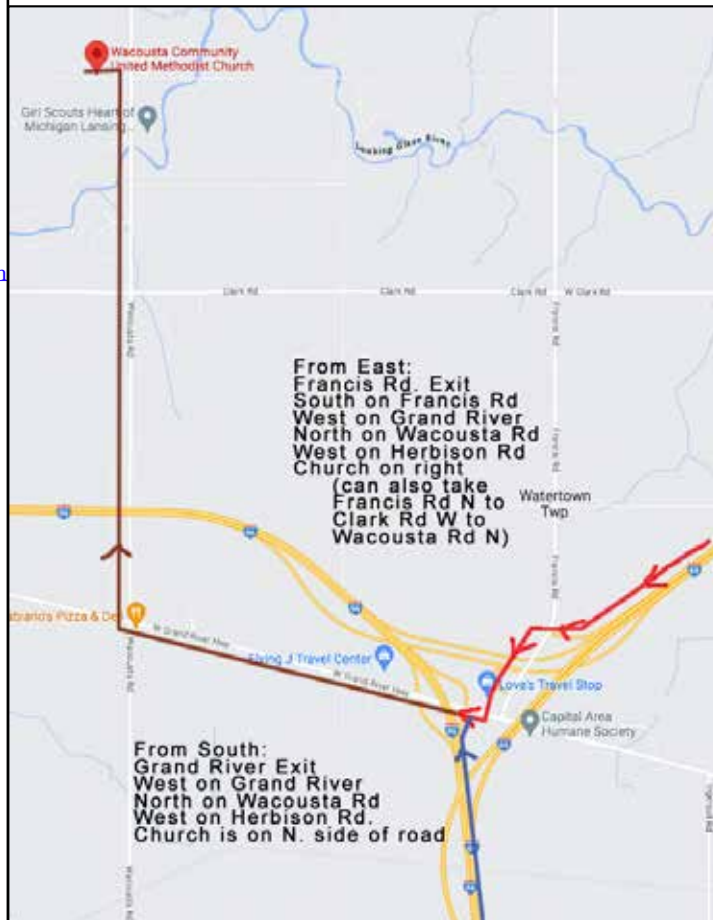
SEPTEMBER 12 MEETING: In-Person at 2:00 p.m.

Wacousta Community United Methodist Church, at 9180 Herbison Rd., Eagle

Our September speaker is Kristen Uthus from New World Orchids.

New World Orchids is a family-owned orchid business in Manchester, Michigan. NWO is owned and operated by Dr. Kristen Uthus with help from her husband, Dr. Kevin Wehrly, and her two sons, Henry and Gus. We specialize in miniature orchids, particularly species, from around the world. We also have one of the widest selections of Neofinetia falcata (a.k.a. Samurai Orchids) and other Japanese orchids in the US. Kristen travels to orchid societies all over the country to talk about orchids and appears at shows in the Midwest and on the East Coast throughout the year.

<https://newworldorchids.com>



Doors open at 1:30 p.m. for:

- Plant shopping
- Experienced Society members will be available to answer questions and help problem solve orchid growing issues
- Please have refreshments in place prior to start of meeting.

Meeting will start promptly at 2:00 pm

Kristen Uthus will bring plants for sale. Come prepared for a few purchases!

Please bring plants for our Show and Tell Table, our Silent Raffle Table and our Auction Table.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE -- Ioana Sonea

As I write this, I'm reminded by the cooling temperatures tonight that summer doesn't last forever, at least not in Michigan.

Like many of you, I need to start preparing the orchids' winter home. Although many orchids benefit from a stint of cooler weather, others really don't like temperatures below 60F or so, and we're going to have some cooler nights soon.

If you're wondering how you're going to fit all your plants back into your growing area, you could make space by bringing any extras to give or sell at our September meeting. And a miniature (or three) from New World Orchids really won't take up much room! 🤔

Hope to see you at the September meeting!

GLOS SHOW NEWS

Hello to the wonderful members of GLOS! It's that time of year again: Time to start thinking about our show on February 27 & 28, 2027. It seems like a long way away and nobody wants to think about February in the middle of August. But we must. The show will be here before we know.

It's time to start looking at your plants to see how to help them be the best that they can be. It's also time to start thinking about how you can help at the show, as most of you know it takes an army to make this show the masterpiece that the public has grown to expect.

Everyone can help in some way, by donating food, money and time and by talking to friends, using social media, staffing a table, clerking for judging, setting up and tearing down the display. There are all sorts of other volunteering opportunities along the way.

So, get ready there will be more information coming soon.
Thank you, Becky Thayer Show Chairman.

GLOS Board meeting: tentative dates (all at 7pm) are:

- Aug 3,
- Oct 6,
- Dec 7
- Feb 1
- Apr 5
- June 7

GLOS Board meetings are held by ZOOM and are open to all members. Contact Dot or Ioana for Zoom link.

Thanks to the members who provided refreshments for our August meeting. Volunteers to provide refreshments for our September meeting include: Becky, Bill and Marilyn Porter, Raechel Portelli and Ioana Sonea

GLOS CALENDAR OF EVENTS.

- September begins our Darker Months meeting time at 2:00 pm
- September 12 - 2:00 pm Kristen Uthus speaking on miniature orchids
- October 10 - 4:00 pm In-Person/ZOOM Manny Aybar: orchids of Peru Please note start time
- November 14 - 2:00 pm Dennis Steinbeck: topic TBD
- November 21-22 AAOS Show Matthaei Botanical Gardens
- January 9 2027 - 2:00 pm Nicholas Rust In-Person/ZOOM topic TBD
- January 23-24 GVOS Show at Meijer Gardens and Sculpture Park
- February 6-7 Three Rivers OS Show
- February 27-28 GLOS SHOW



BOARD APPROVED BUDGET FOR 2026 - 2027 -- Submitted by Pete Ostlund, Treasurer

ITEM/ACTIVITY	Approved 2026-2027 budget	
	INCOME	EXPENSE
Show Related		
Show tables (30 total)	\$3,080.00	
Show site		\$2,250.00
Advertizing, postcards		\$550.00
Show food	\$800.00	\$1,800.00
Orchids-in-use Allowance/Art	\$100.00	\$300.00
Other show items (moss, ribbons, copying, trophies,etc)	\$450.00	\$1,199.00
Information table (Book sales @ show and donations). Expenses book purchases.	\$400.00	\$200.00
Expenses for future shows (beyond 2027), such as ribbons, tags, supplies		
Subtotal Show	\$4,830.00	\$6,299.00
Administrative		
Building rental (@\$50 for 8 in-person meetings), picnic rental @\$50	\$50.00	\$515.00
Liability insurance		\$449.00
Misc (website rental @50, tax-exempt registration @\$20, dues to AOS \$176 for 2 years and MAOC @\$50)		\$296.00
Copying (Calypso, culture sheets, flyers etc)		\$180.00
Postage		\$110.00
Donations to cover Calypso	\$50.00	
Subtotal Administrative	\$100.00	\$1,550.00
Programs		
Speaker's fees, dinner/hotel (assumes 8 in-person/zoom speakers) at \$300 each if unknown		\$2,400.00
Picnic, silent auctions, raffles	\$2,785.00	
misc. income/expenses		
Subtotal Programs	\$2,785.00	\$2,400.00
Exhibiting at Other Shows		
Van rentals for away shows (this is not entire amount, driver often covers part of the cost)		\$500.00
supplies (moss, stakes, etc.)		\$130.00
Subtotal Exhibiting at Other Shows	\$0.00	\$630.00
Contributions/Interest/Dues		
Miscellaneous income donations, etc., Expenses include donations to GLJC @\$150, Nature Conservancy @\$100 and Michigan Nature Association @\$100		\$350.00
Memberships	\$700.00	
Miscellaneous donations	\$3,100.00	
Interest income	\$400.00	
Subtotal Contributions/Interest/Dues	\$4,200.00	\$350.00
TOTALS	\$11,915.00	\$11,229.00
NET	\$686.00	

Submitted by Pete Ostlund, Treasurer

GREATER LANSING ORCHID SOCIETY FINANCIAL REPORT for the period July 1, 2026 - July 31, 2026 report dated August 2, 2026		EXPENSES	
Balance on hand July 1, 2026	\$19,135.45	2027 GLOS Annual Show	
Cash-on-Hand	\$200.00	Other show items (moss, ribbons, copying, trophies, etc)	
Checking	\$1,054.37	Doris Asher	\$553.00 2027 Show Ribbons
Saving	\$5.01	Doris Asher	\$44.18 Colored paper for GLOS culture sheets for 2027
IMMA	\$3,028.39	subtotal show	\$597.18
5 CD's	\$14,847.68	Administrative	
CD 4 (matures 10/03/2028) 3.78%	\$1,907.72	West Bend Liability Insurance	\$449.00
CD 7 (matures 5/27/2027) 1.98%	\$4,084.20	Misc (website rental @\$50, tax-exempt registration @\$20, dues to AOS and MAOC @\$115)	
CD 8 (matures 06/25/2027) 2.47%	\$1,751.47	Doris Asher	\$176.00 GLOS AOS dues for 2 years
CD 9 (matures 7/31/2029) 3.445%	\$2,860.99	Doris Asher	\$50.00 1000 sale-tax free copies
CD A (matures 7/31/2026) 0.99 %	\$516.42	Doris Asher	\$5.98 Laminating new signs for Raffle and for Silent Auction
CD G (matures 10/13/2026) 3.40%	\$3,726.88	Postage	
INCOME		Doris Asher	\$24.91 Postage to mail March, May and July 2026 newsletters
Programs		subtotal admin	\$705.89
Picnic, silent auctions, raffles		TOTAL EXPENSES	\$1,303.07
Picnic plant sales	\$1,863.00	NET INCOME (based on above transactions)	\$3,836.57
Contributions/Interest/Dues		Balance at close of reporting period	<i>balance from below</i>
Membership		Balance on hand July 31, 2026	\$22,972.02
Becky Thayer	\$8.00	Cash-on-Hand	\$200.00
Jerrie Nichols	\$8.00	Checking	\$5,369.14
Dawn Kittle	\$8.00	Saving	\$5.01
Marilyn Whittaker	\$8.00	IMMA	\$3,030.95
Bill Cadman	\$8.00	5 CD's	\$14,366.92
Mike Underwood	\$8.00	CD 4 (matures 10/03/2028) 3.78%	\$1,913.85
Jill Wood	\$80.00	CD 7 (matures 5/27/2027) 1.98%	\$4,091.08
David Ash	\$8.00	CD 8 (matures 06/25/2027) 2.47%	\$1,755.15
subtotal memberships	\$136.00	CD 9 (matures 7/31/2029) 3.445%	\$2,869.36
Miscellaneous Donations		CD A (matures 7/31/2026) 0.99 %	\$0.00
Marilyn Whittaker	\$2.00	CD G (matures 10/13/2026) 3.40%	\$3,737.48
Ioana	\$100.00		
Doris Asher	\$3,000.00		
subtotal misc. donations	\$3,102.00		
Interest Income			
July	\$38.64		
TOTAL INCOME	\$5,139.64		

USED ORCHID BOOKS/PERIODICALS WANTED

Do you have some orchid books or orchid periodicals that you no longer want? We need them at our Orchid Show, where visitors to the Show snap them up very quickly. Because the items are donated, the Society makes 100% profit. We use the orchid magazines as free giveaways to Show visitors to encourage their joining our Society.

Because this service is so popular, we would like to offer inexpensive, used orchid books again at this February's Show. Since GLOS is an IRS not-for-profit 501©3 organization, you may deduct the value of the books and magazines you give us. The Treasurer will be happy to provide you a receipt for your gift.

Please consider giving such items at this September meeting to Doris Asher.





Raechel Portelli

Evelyne Cudel

Dan Greiner



**PHOTOS FROM OUR
SHOW AND TELL
TABLE,
MEMBERSHIP
MEETING AUGUST 2026**

Photos by Dot & Becky



Al Jacobus



Pete Ostlund



Dot Barnett

MEETING MINUTES FOR AUGUST MEMBER MEETING: -Submitted by Dan Greiner, Secretary

Meeting started at 6:05 on August 8th.

Around 29 members attended.

Ioana started by thanking members who brought refreshments for the September 12th meeting (Christine Granger, Dave Madison, Ioana, and somebody else – We neglected to record), and asked for **volunteers for the next meeting (Becky, Bill and Marilyn Porter, Raechel Portelli and Ioana Sonea** volunteered).

She reminded members of the upcoming meetings:

- Sept 12 Kristen Uthus from New World Orchids will present Miniature Orchids Part 2 and will bring plants for sale.
- October 10th, Manny Aybar will present Orchids of Peru via Zoom.
- November 14th we are hoping to host Dennis Steinbeck from Flask and Flora, he will have plants for sale.
- January, Nicholas Rust will give a Zoom presentation (topic TBD), the meeting will be in person if weather permits.

Budget has been approved by the board hopefully will be breaking even.

Outside events:

- Members should consider attending the Ohio Valley Orchid fest August 21-23, it's an excellent venue, lots of vendors and great talks. GLOS will purchase a license so all members can view the presentations online.
- Ann Arbor is the first show, on November 21-22, at the Matthaei Gardens.

Vice President Becky Thayer reminded members that GLOS will need lots of help with the February show. Becky also asked if anyone should be willing to overwinter around 8 orchids for a non-member.

Paph Paradise is still taking pre-orders.

Show and tell table: many beautiful plants were shared. (see p5)

Presentations on growing set-ups by Dot Barnett, Rob Halgren, Carol Stuht, Jill Wood, and Megan Parrott concluded the meeting, which ended shortly after 8:pm.

**WEAR YOUR BADGE TO OUR SEPTEMBER MEETING**

Your Society relies on each member to hold onto his or her GLOS name badge. Please wear your badge to our meeting on September 12th. Let's help everyone greet everyone by name by wearing a name tag. If you cannot locate your name tag, kindly let either Dot or Doris know. Dot will make you a new one.

Doris will have the name badges at the meeting that have not yet been picked up by members. She will have write-on name tags for visitors and for anyone who forgot his or her official badge.

As an incentive to wear the name tag, anyone who wears the badge AND purchases even one raffle ticket at \$1.00 per ticket will get a complimentary raffle ticket.

Wear your Society name tag. Get an extra raffle ticket!

Doris Asher, Chair, Membership Committee
Dot Barnett

GLOS BOARD ZOOM MEETING MINUTES August 3rd -Submitted by Dan Greiner, Secretary

1. Call to Order / Attendance The meeting was attended by board members including Ioana Sonea, Dorothy Barnett, William Cadman, Becky Thayer, Doris Asher, Teresa Fowle, Peter Ostlund, Daniel Greiner and Michele Bridges. It was noted that Jerrie Nichols joined later.
2. Treasurer's Report (July) Peter Ostlund presented the July treasurer's report. Opening balance was over \$19,000. Income for July included picnic plant sales of over \$1,800, memberships of \$136, a \$3,000 donation from Doris Asher, a \$100 donation from Ioana, and interest income, totaling over \$5,000. Expenses totaled approximately \$1,300, including show expenses and insurance. Net income was nearly \$4,000, bringing the bank balance to almost \$23,000. A previously held \$500 CD at 1% was allowed to expire and funds moved to checking. A new 6-month CD at 3-4% is being considered.
3. Budget Approval Peter presented the proposed budget for the current fiscal year, comparing it to last year's approved budget and actual figures. The budget projects a modest surplus of approximately \$700. Becky moved to accept the proposed budget, Ioana seconded, and the motion passed unanimously. Planned donations of \$350 total to the Great Lakes Judging Center, Michigan Nature Association, and the Nature Conservancy will be sent. Peter will prepare a summary for the Calypso newsletter.
4. Membership Committee Report - Submitted by: Doris Asher, Membership Committee Chair
 1. Membership Statistics & Trends
 - Current Status: 112 members across 102 households (compared to 113 members in 101 households at this time last year).
 - Life Members: Increased from 59 (52.7%) in June to 60 (53.6%) by August.
 2. Activity & Renewals (April – August 2026)
 - New Members: One new member joined.
 - Spring Renewals: Twelve members renewed between April and June.
 - Summer Picnic (July 11): Seven members renewed,.
 - Late July Renewals: One additional renewal received
 - 3 Newsletter (Calypso) Distribution & Costs
 - Distribution Breakdown: 90 households (89.2%) receive electronic copies; 11 households (10.8%) receive paper copies.
 - Mailing Update: Due to post office transit damage, paper copies are now sent in envelopes. This has adjusted postage to \$1.07 per stamp.
 - Cost Analysis:
 - o Electronic delivery incurs no printing or postage costs.
 - o Paper production costs \$3.60/year per household.
 - o Combined paper and postage costs \$10.02/year per household.
 - o Total annual paper distribution cost is \$110.22, which is historically offset by voluntary member donations requested on dues forms.

The Board then reviewed the annual picnic. It was generally considered a success, with plant sales of about \$1,800 and roughly the same attendance as the previous year. Suggestions for improvement included better organization of personal plants versus sale plants, and possibly bringing a portable canopy to provide extra shade and space.

There was a brief discussion about the GLOS website, with some members noting difficulty opening the Calypso newsletter on mobile devices. Pete confirmed it worked fine on his computer, and the group agreed to ask the membership for feedback at the next meeting.

Finally, the Board had a broader discussion about increasing the club's visibility and attracting new members.

Pete confirmed he regularly posts on the GLOS Facebook page. Daniel raised the idea of increasing social media presence across platforms, particularly YouTube, to attract younger members. The group agreed to start by doing short video interviews with upcoming vendor speakers (Rob, Dennis, and a New World vendor) to post on social media. Daniel volunteered to conduct the interviews and will prepare interview questions to share with the group in advance.

Other topics included a discussion on life membership levels and what other societies do, an update on future meeting speakers (covered through January, spotty after that), and a note that the October 10th meeting may need to start later than usual due to a church event. Dot agreed to contact the church about the time.

Meeting ended at 8:13pm

PICNIC 2026

ORCHIDIST OF THE YEAR:

DAN GREINER

CONGRATULATIONS, Dan!



Our
auctioneers:

Mike
Underwood
and
daughter
Steph

Pete
Show and Tell



You are the winner!!



Shopping time:
Lots of plants to choose from.



A short meeting, then a great spread of picnic fare with our yearly fun auction following.



And plenty of time to chat with friends before and after the auction.



See you next year!

GOOD NEWS !!!

Our website is now up to date with the speaker schedule and locations at www.gljc.org

August 15 Dave Sorokowsky of Paph Paradise will be our special speaker on "Judging Maudiae Paphs". Dave will take pre-paid pre-orders via their website at www.paphparadise.com no later than August 8. AOS Judging will begin no later than 12:30 PM EDT.

September 19 "Rhyncholaelia digbyana – A Beautiful and an Exceptional Parent" with Sandra Micucci from GLJC. AOS Judging will begin no later than 12:30 PM EDT.

October 17 Jill Wood from GLJC will speak on "Current Development of Mini-Phrag Hybrids". AOS Judging will begin no later than 12:30 PM EDT.

For more information contact Dave Miller at dcmpasmil@aol.com, especially if you are not familiar with the location or process.

**FROM RAY BARKELOW OF FIRST RAY'S ORCHIDS NEWSLETTER****WATERING: DRENCH OR DUNK?**

Water is the true driving force for growth, and a well-watered plant will grow and bloom better than one that is not as hydrated. Many orchid growers assume that leaving a plant submerged for an extended period will result in greater hydration than a simple watering. While soaking certainly has its place, orchid root physiology suggests that periodic drenching may be just as effective — sometimes more so and often more practical — for maximizing water uptake.

Orchid roots are designed to capture water quickly. The velamen, the spongy outer layer covering the roots, can become saturated within 30 seconds to a few minutes of exposure to water. Once saturated, water begins moving into the living tissues of the root and throughout the plant. Research and grower experience indicate that most of this uptake occurs during the first 15 to 30 minutes after wetting.

Because of this rapid absorption, the benefits of prolonged soaking diminish quickly. A one-hour soak generally provides only marginally more hydration than a 20- to 30-minute soak. Beyond that point, the roots continue to absorb water, but at a much slower rate as the plant approaches equilibrium.

Periodic drenching takes advantage of this same rapid uptake mechanism. A thorough watering saturates the velamen and root zone, initiating the same absorption process that occurs during soaking. If the roots are drenched again after they have begun to dry, the plant receives another opportunity for rapid uptake. In effect, multiple wetting cycles can stimulate repeated periods of particularly efficient absorption.

This mirrors the conditions under which many epiphytic orchids evolved. In nature, roots are rarely submerged for hours. Instead, they experience frequent rainfall, dew, or mist events that thoroughly wet the roots. Orchid roots evolved to exploit these brief hydration opportunities.

There are situations where soaking can be beneficial. Severely dehydrated plants, orchids growing in highly water-repellent media, and species with exceptionally thick roots may benefit from extended immersion to ensure complete wetting. However, for routine watering, prolonged soaking often provides little additional benefit compared to a thorough drench.

For growers whose primary goal is maximizing water uptake, which maximizes growth and flowering, the evidence suggests that success depends less on the duration of a single watering event and more on achieving complete wetting of the root system whenever water is applied. Once the roots are fully saturated, repeated wetting cycles are often more effective than keeping them submerged for extended periods.

Other advantages of drenching over soaking is flushing fertilizer residues and plants wastes from the medium and aerating it. Consider these scenarios for two pots containing the same level of contamination:

Pot One is set into a tub of fresh water and allowed to soak for an extended period of time. Over that period, some of the contaminants, which are primarily deposited near the top surface of the medium due to accelerated evaporation, will dissolve in the water and be spread uniformly throughout the medium and absorbed. Meanwhile, being submerged, there is no gas exchange happening in the roots.

Pot Two is placed in the sink and a heavy "shower" of water is directed to the top surface of the potting mix. That "simulated rainfall" will mostly flush any contaminants down through medium column and out the bottom of the container. The motion of the water also entrains air, drawing it down through the mix, thoroughly oxygenating it at the same time.

Until next time... Good Growing!



ORCHID CONSERVATION ALLIANCE

An opportunity to travel to see the orchids of South Africa.

<https://orchidconservationalliance.org/trip-orchids-of-drakensberg/>



Littlefrog Farm

Rob Halgren, PhD

PO Box 26

Holt, MI 48842

<http://littlefrogfarm.com>

rob@littlefrogfarm.com

Jump into Orchids !

GLOS Advertising Policy

Commercial members may advertise their orchid businesses in the Calypso at no extra charge. Ads will appear as space is available and in the order they are received. Advertisers are responsible for preparing their ads. Standing Ads size should normally be 2" x 3" but exceptions may be made for special events. Submissions will be considered a one-time-only unless designated as standing ads. Please check the stated deadline for submission to any Calypso issue. Submissions may be made via email or regular mail.

Non-commercial members may also advertise orchid related items in the Calypso under the above conditions.

GLOS MEMBERSHIP

Our GLOS numbers stand now as follows: as of August 8th -- 121 members in 111 households. At this same time last year, we had 113 members in 101 households. We have received renewals for 2026-2027 from David Ash, Chris Brown, Bill Cadman, Evelyn Cudel, Marshall Gordon, Christine Granger, Al Jacobus, Dawn Kittle, Barbara McAllister, Mary Jane Miller, Jerrie Nichols, Jack Shumaker (paying for two years 2026-27 and 2027-28), Linda Stephenson, Becky Thayer, Mike Underwood, Marilyn Whittaker; Jill Wood renewed with a Lifetime Membership! We have not received renewals from twelve members, who have been dropped from our distribution for future newsletters or other Society mailings. If Dot and I can get them to renew, they will be reinstated immediately. Sixty-one of our 121 members are Life Members. Ninety percent of our membership receive their newsletters via email at no cost to the Society.

Doris Asher, Membership Committee

SHOW SEASON BEGINS

GLOS plans to put a display in these upcoming shows:

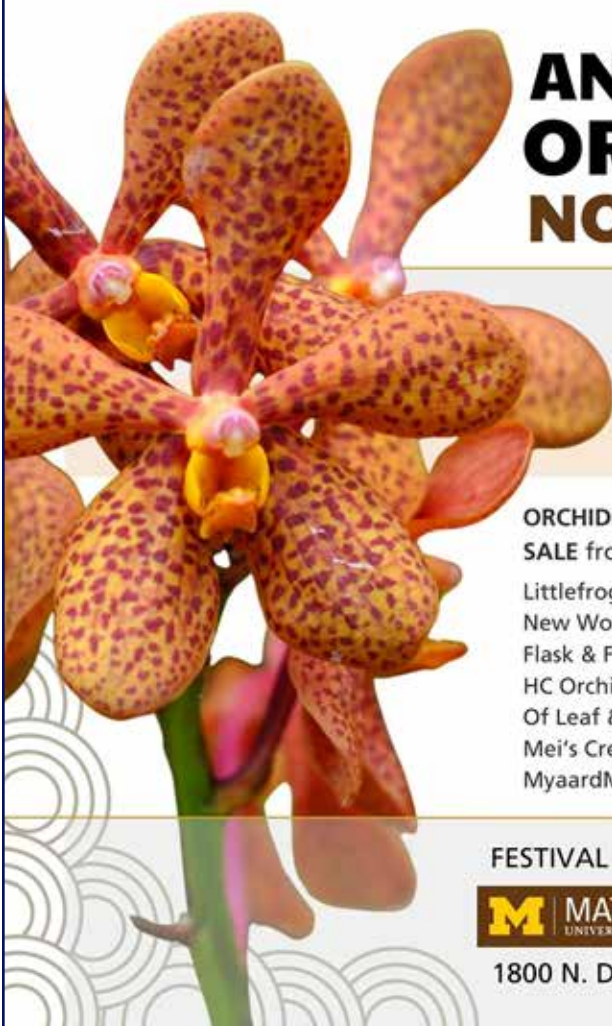
The Ann Arbor Orchid Festival will be November 21-22, 2026, with setup on Friday the 20th. The show will be at the Matthaei Botanical Gardens in Ann Arbor.

The Grand Valley Orchid Society's Show will be held on January 23rd and 24th, 2027, with setup on Friday the 22nd. Their Show is at the Meijer Gardens & Sculpture Park, in Grand Rapids.

The Three Rivers Orchid Society has scheduled their Show on February 6th and 7th, 2027, with setup on Friday the 5th; the location is the Botanical Conservatory in Fort Wayne, IN.

Carol Ann Stuht is our Away Shows Chair and would love to have you help with any of these displays. If you are interested in learning how to set up a display, please contact her at castuht@gmail.com or 517-896-4070.





ANN ARBOR ORCHID FESTIVAL NOVEMBER 21 & 22, 2026

SHOW & SALE HOURS: 10am to 4pm

PHOTOGRAPHERS' HOUR: Sun 9am-10am

FREE ADMISSION * ORCHID RAFFLES * ORCHID DISPLAYS *
FAMILY-FRIENDLY EVENT!

ORCHIDS & ORCHID RELATED ITEMS FOR SALE from these vendors:

Littlefrog Farm * Natt's Orchids *
New World Orchids * Ecuagenera *
Flask & Flora * Dr. Bill's Orchids *
HC Orchids * Mound & Magick Pottery *
Of Leaf & Limb * Lady Orchid House *
Mei's Creations* Suphattra's Clay Flowers *
MyaardMade* Jen's Gemshop* Sue Trager

The following **FREE CLASSES** will
be available on both Saturday &
Sunday in Room 125.
Please join us!

- 11am - Basics of Growing Orchids
- 1:30pm - How to Repot or Mount
Your Orchid

FESTIVAL LOCATION:

M MATTHAEI BOTANICAL GARDENS
UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN

1800 N. Dixboro Rd, Ann Arbor MI

